

Post-incident review PIR-2026-019

Identity Platform: failed sign-ins

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 14 March 2026, Identity Platform experienced failed sign-ins in production (AU Southeast) for about 240 minutes. The error-rate alert paged the on-call engineer. Investigation found that a null reference in the new release crashed workers on a rare input.

Impact

Users of Identity Platform saw failed sign-ins for about 240 minutes. The service owner, Identity and Access, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:18 First signal received.
- 09:35 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:43 Likely cause identified.
- 10:00 Mitigation applied.
- 10:47 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a null reference in the new release crashed workers on a rare input.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.